047 | LIVE SESSION | ~75 MIN + Q&A

AI Skills:
Teach AI How You Work

So you stop repeating yourself.

JACKSON | @CTRLSWING | Vibe Marketers

"I'm not an expert."

This stuff is months old. Nobody's an expert yet. But I've been building with it daily. I'll show you what's been working for me.

BUILDER, NOT PROFESSOR

RUN OF SHOW

What We'll Cover

~10 min	The Ecosystem
~15 min	What Skills Are
~15 min	Building a Skill
~25 min	Live Demos
~5 min	Safety + Resources
~5 min	Your Takeaway

01

The Ecosystem

Different tools for different jobs.

005 | ECOSYSTEM

Three Tools, Three Jobs

MCP Servers

CONNECTORS

The wiring. Connects AI to external data and tools.

Think of it as the power outlets in the room.

Sub-Agents

THE TEAM

AI delegating tasks to other AI. A project manager assigning work.

Think of it as a PM distributing tasks.

Skills

THE PLAYBOOK

Instructions that tell AI how to do a specific job, step by step, every time.

Think of it as your best SOP, written for AI.

> MCP is the wiring. Sub-agents are the team. Skills are the playbook.

Skills range from a simple SKILL.md to full packages with reference files, scripts, and API calls. Slash commands are the older pattern — they're being merged into skills.

006 | TIMELINE

How Recent Is All of This?

Jun 2024 Artifacts

Oct 2024	Computer Use
Nov 2024	MCP Protocol
Feb 2025	Claude Code
Oct 2025	Skills launch
Dec 2025	Skills become open standard

> Eighteen months ago, none of this existed.

007 | ADOPTION

This Spread Fast

Claude Desktop | Claude Code | Cursor | Codex | Cline | Manus | + more

Anthropic released skills in October. By December, open standard. Same pattern as MCP.

What you learn today works across tools.

SECTION 02

02

What Skills Are

The 60-second version.

009 | DEFINITION

Skills in 60 Seconds

A skill is a markdown file with instructions AI follows. That's it. One file is all you need to start.

```
my-skill/
├── SKILL.md          # Required
├── scripts/          # Optional — runnable code
├── references/       # Optional — docs, guides
└── assets/           # Optional — templates
```

Start with just SKILL.md. Add the rest as you grow.

What a SKILL.md Looks Like

The frontmatter is what AI reads first. The body is what it follows.

```
---
name: Google Search Campaign Architect
description: |
  Generates a full Google Ads search campaign
  from a landing page URL. Use when user says
  "build a campaign" or "Google Ads".
---

# Instructions

## Input
- Landing page URL (required)
- Monthly budget (optional)

## Steps
1. Fetch and analyze the landing page
2. Extract value props, audience, proof points
3. Build keyword groups with match types
4. Write headlines + descriptions per ad group
5. Add negative keywords and extensions

## Output
- Full campaign brief with ad group structure
- Copy-paste ready for Google Ads
```

Frontmatter — name + description. This is what AI scans to decide if the skill matches.

Body — the actual instructions. Only loaded when the skill is triggered.

011 | HOW IT WORKS

How Skills Actually Work

Skills load in three levels. Not everything at once.

01

YAML Frontmatter

Name + description. Always loaded.

02

SKILL.md Body

Full instructions. Loaded on match.

03

Linked Files

Scripts, references. Loaded on demand.

> You can have 20+ skills enabled. Claude only loads what it needs, when it needs it.

The Description Makes or Breaks It

The description is what Claude reads to decide whether to load your skill. Get this right and it auto-triggers. Get it wrong and it sits there unused.

[What it does] + [When to use it] + [Key capabilities]

BAD

"Generates Google Ads campaigns."

GOOD

"Generates a full Google Ads search campaign from a landing page URL. Use when user says 'build a campaign' or 'Google Ads'."

Keep the SKILL.md body concise. Under 5,000 words. Move detailed docs to references/.

013 | PERSONAL VS. GENERIC

The Best Skills Are Personal

GENERIC

"Write Google Ads copy."

PERSONAL

"Write Google Ads copy for my SaaS product that targets mid-market CFOs, uses our specific value props, avoids competitor terms we've tested, and follows our brand voice."

Your brand voice

Your audience

Your positioning

The most useful skills aren't templates. They're your playbook.

014 | CLARITY

What Skills Are NOT

Not integrations	That's MCP. Skills are pure instructions.
Not AI managing AI	That's sub-agents. Skills are the playbook, not the org chart.
Not saved prompts	Prompts vanish after one chat. Skills persist and improve.
Not autopilot	Skills guide the work. You still judge the output.

> A skill is a playbook, not the player.

SECTION 03

03

Building Skills

Let's make one together.

What Makes a Good Skill?

Repeatable

You do it more than once.

Explainable

You could explain it to a sharp colleague.

Contained

Clear start. Clear end.

If you can describe it in plain language, you can turn it into a skill.

017 | LIVE ~15 MIN

Let’s Build It

01

Describe what we want

02

Claude drafts the SKILL.md

03

We refine the instructions

04

Test it on a real example

Open Claude → Settings → Capabilities → Skill Creator → Try in chat

That’s a skill.

Started with an idea from the room. Described it in plain language. Claude wrote the instructions. We tested it.

No code. No config. Just words.

018 | ITERATE

Skills Improve With Use

A skill isn't finished when you ship it. Watch for two signals, then adjust.

UNDERTRIGGERING

Skill doesn’t load when it should

Users have to manually enable it. You keep getting asked "when do I use this?"

Fix: Add more trigger phrases and detail to the description.

OVERTRIGGERING

Skill loads when it shouldn’t

Fires on unrelated queries. Users start disabling it.

Fix: Be more specific. Add negative triggers — "Do NOT use for X."

> Every skill you build gets better over time. Ship it, watch it, refine it.

SECTION 04

04

Live Demos

Three real workflows you can steal.

What We're Demoing

01 Search Campaign Architect

CLAUDE DESKTOP · LIVE BUILD

I run Google Ads at my day job. This skill builds full campaigns from a URL.

02 Branded HTML Email

CLAUDE DESKTOP · LIVE BUILD

I have a side business in maintenance mode. This skill keeps emails on-brand without me.

03 Ad Creative Refresher

CLAUDE CODE + NANO BANANA PRO

My coworkers run static ads. This skill generates fresh variations of winners.

DEMO 01 | LIVE BUILD

Google Search Campaign Architect

I rebuild Google Ads campaigns every week at work. This skill takes a URL and drafts the whole thing — copy-paste ready into Google Ads.

> First-draft builder, not an autonomous ad buyer. General skill, transferrable across orgs.

RUN SKILL IN CLAUDE →

DEMO 02 | LIVE BUILD

Branded HTML Email Generator

I have a side business but no time to write emails. This skill holds my brand voice, colors, and copy rules — topic in, finished email out.

> This skill holds everything about my business. Brand voice, colors, layout, copy rules. This is what "personal skills" look like.

RUN SKILL IN CLAUDE →

DEMO 03 | CLAUDE CODE + NANO BANANA PRO

Ad Creative Refresher

My coworkers run static ads and constantly need fresh variations of winners. This skill handles the creative logic — Claude Code + Nano Banana Pro (Gemini image generation).

Requires Gemini API key. Free tier available.

> Claude Code handles the creative logic. Nano Banana Pro generates the images. You bring the winning ad.

024 | REMIX

The Remix Mindset

You don't need to start from scratch. Clone, study, adapt. The fastest path.

01 Open a public skill repo

02 Read the name and description

03 Skim the steps

04 Identify inputs and outputs

05 Keep structure, swap your domain

06 Test with normal and edge-case prompts

SEE A REMIX IN ACTION →

SECTION 05

05

Safety + Resources

Treat skills like software installs.

Safety Checklist

- Read the full instructions before running.
- Watch for hidden scripts or broad permissions.
- Check who published it and when.
- Test in a safe environment first.
- If something feels off, don't install it.

Where to Find Skills

Official GitHub Repos

Highest trust. Anthropic-maintained.

Well-Known Org Repos

Good trust. Established builders and teams.

Marketplaces

Use with care. Read before you run.

RESOURCES

anthropics/skills

Anthropic's official repo

github.com/anthropics/skills

openai/skills

OpenAI's official Codex skills catalog

github.com/openai/skills

Composio Skills

50+ curated skills across 9 categories

github.com/ComposioHQ/awesome-claude-skills

SECTION 06

06

Your Takeaway

One thing to remember.

Start with one workflow.
Build one skill.
Repeat.

Every skill you build is time you get back, and context you never have to repeat.

"Skills don't replace judgment. They preserve it."

Now go build something.

@CTRLSWING | QUESTIONS?

QR Code - Build your first skill

Scan to build your first skill right now.

CHANNEL47.DEV/BUILD

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